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(54) **LENS BARREL AND IMAGING DEVICE**

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ABSTRACT

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Related U.S. Application Data

(63) Continuation of application No. 18/630,026, filed on Apr. 9, 2024, now Pat. No. 12,332,499, which is a continuation of application No. 17/430,486, filed on Aug. 12, 2021, filed as application No. PCT/JP2019/049636 on Dec. 18, 2019, now Pat. No. 11,982,868.

Foreign Application Priority Data

Feb. 22, 2019 (JP) 2019-030092

A lens barrel and an imaging device which can be miniaturized, the lens barrel with a movable cylinder that moves along the optical axis with a change in focal length; first and second drive units in the movable cylinder; and first and second lens driven by the first and second drive units respectively to move along the optical axis relative to the movable cylinder. The movement amount of the first lens relative to the cylinder when the focal length is changed to a second focal length from a first state where the first lens is at a position closest to a subject with a first focal length is less than the movement amount of the first lens relative to the cylinder when the focal length is changed to the second focal length from a second state where the first lens is closer to an image plane than the first state.

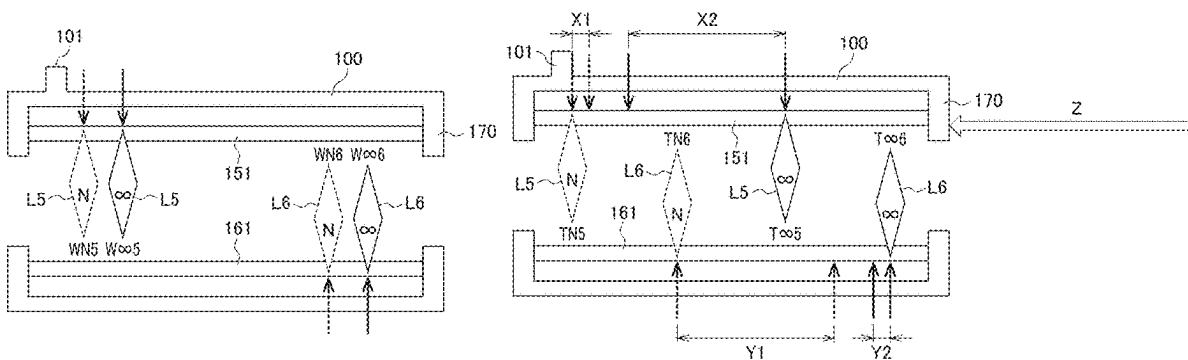


FIG. 1

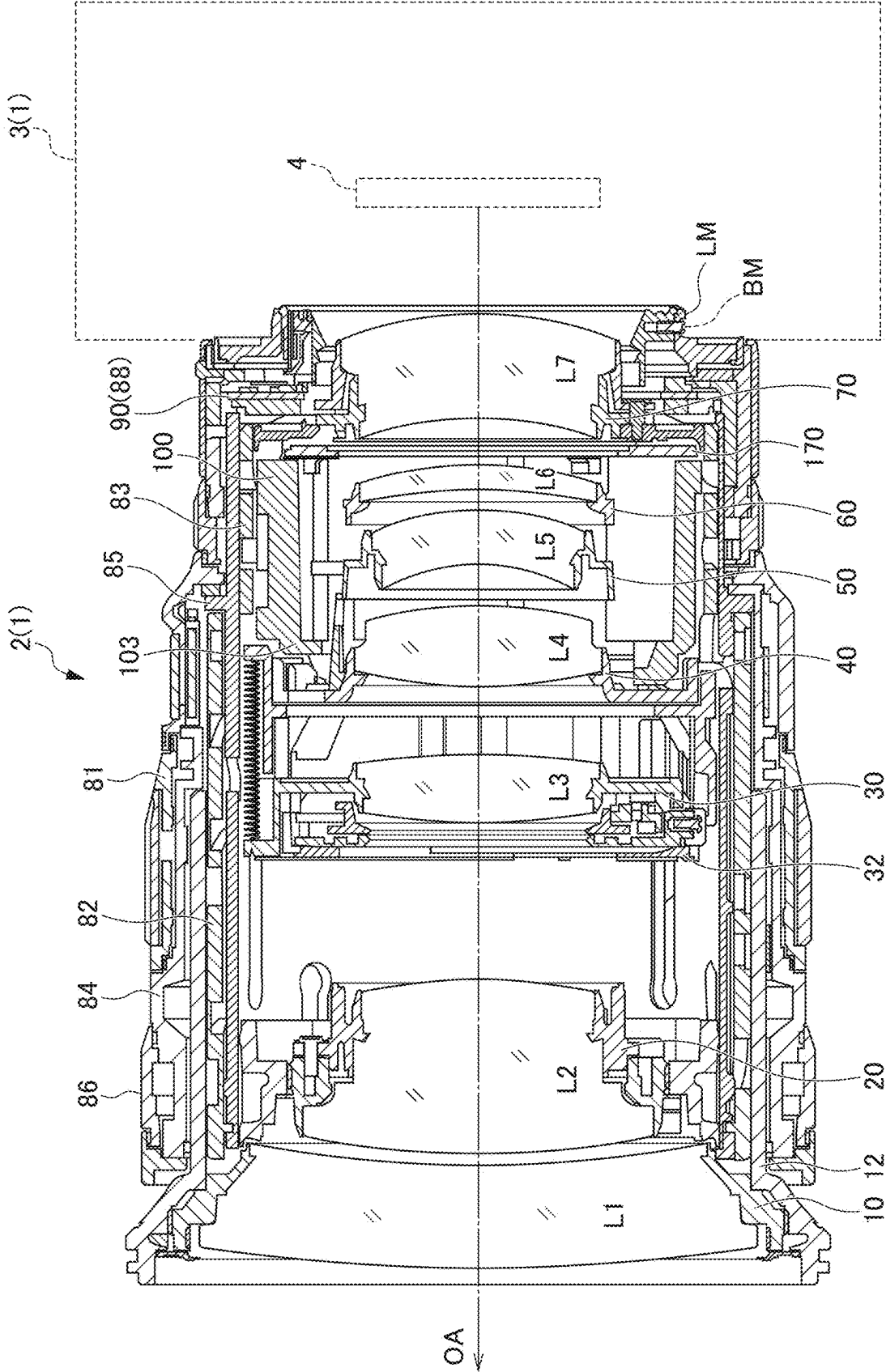


FIG. 2

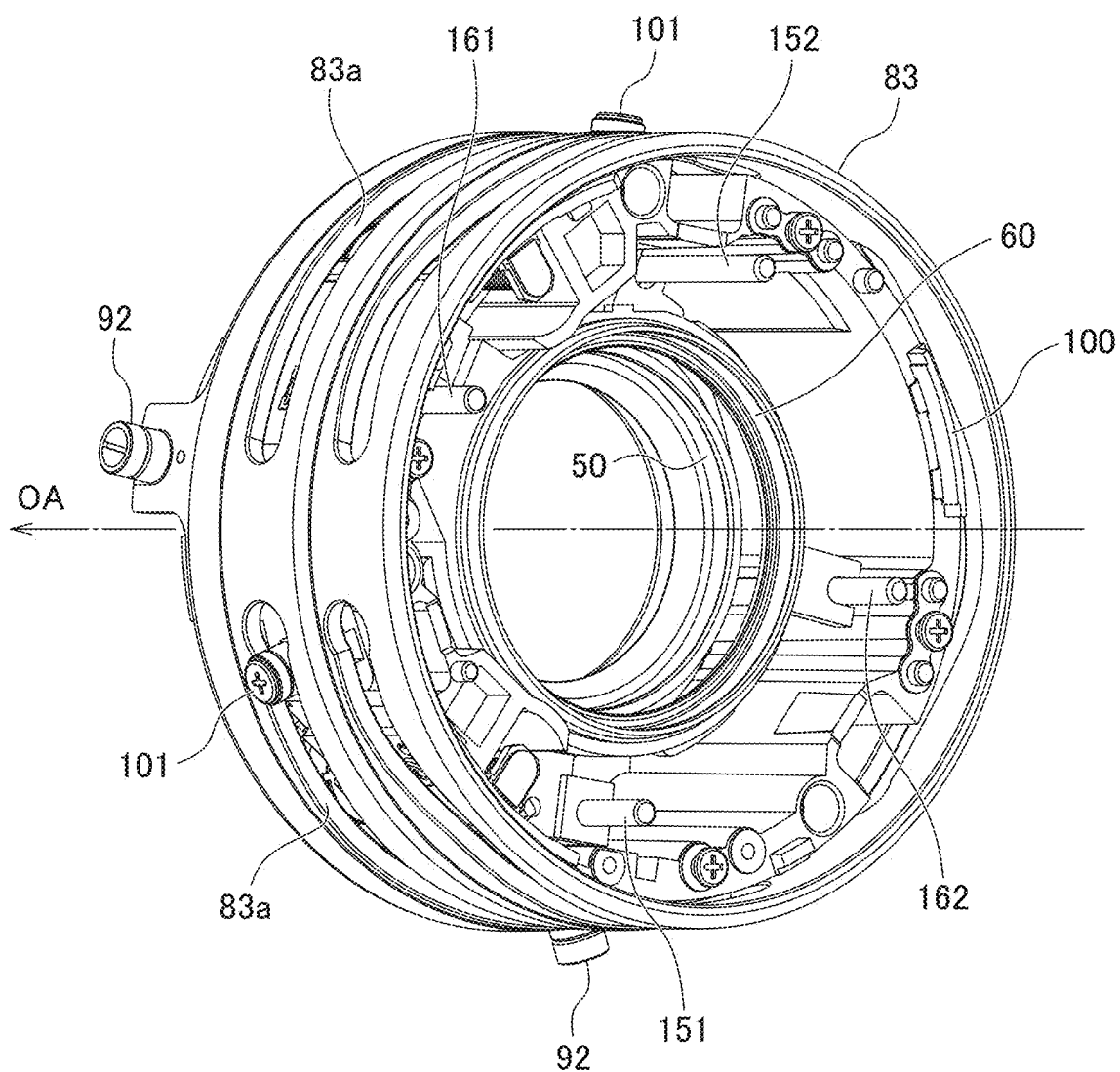


FIG. 3

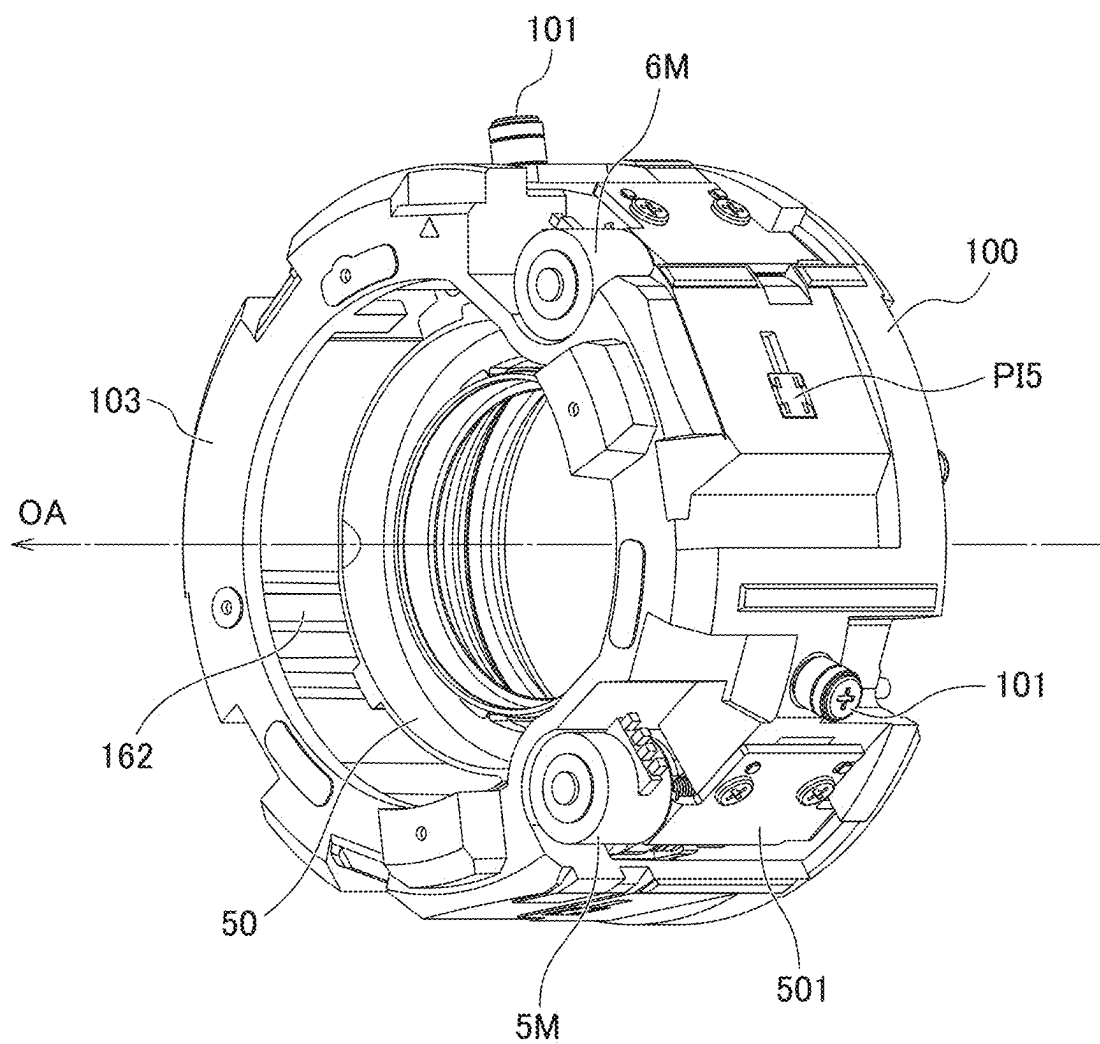


FIG. 4

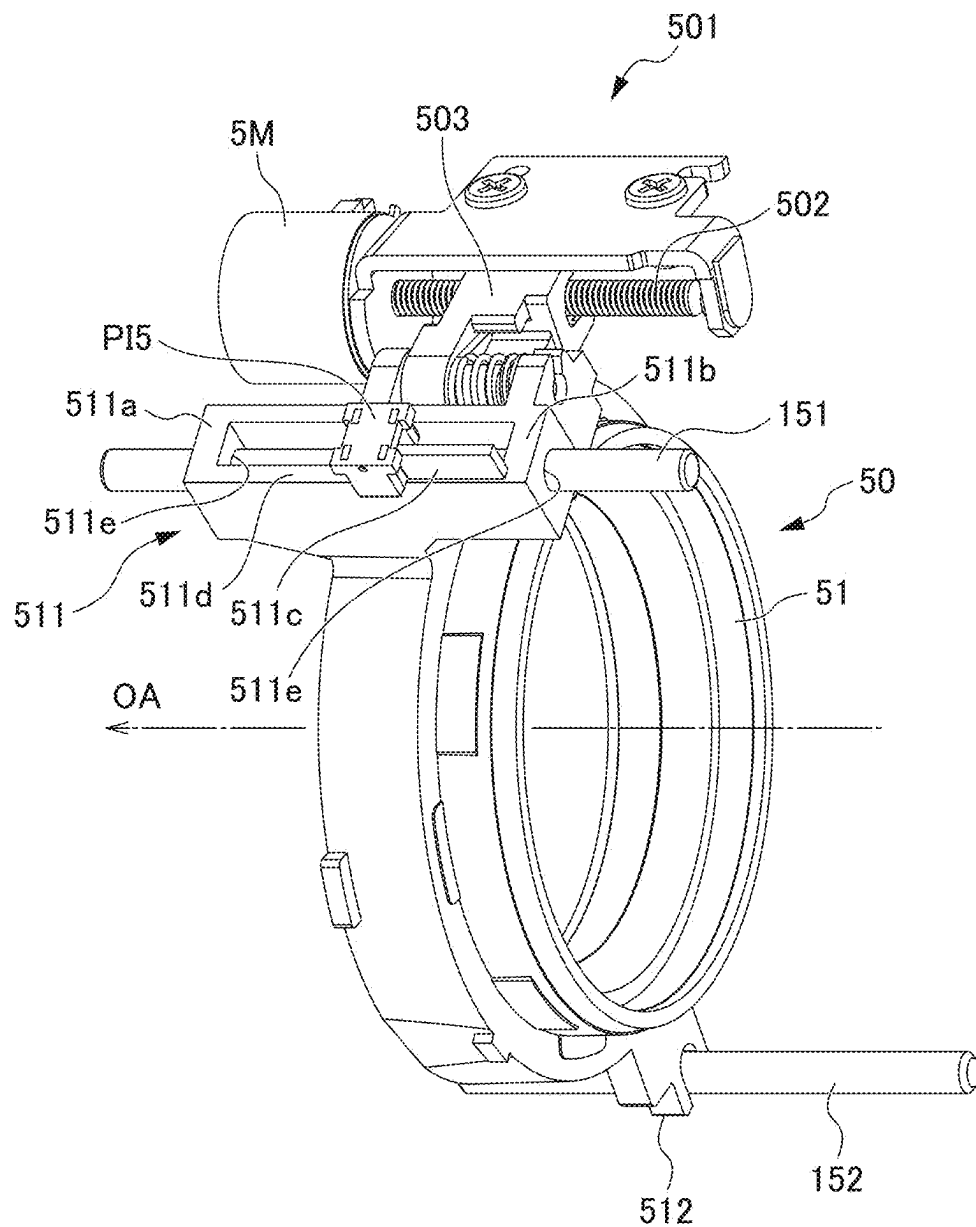


FIG. 5A

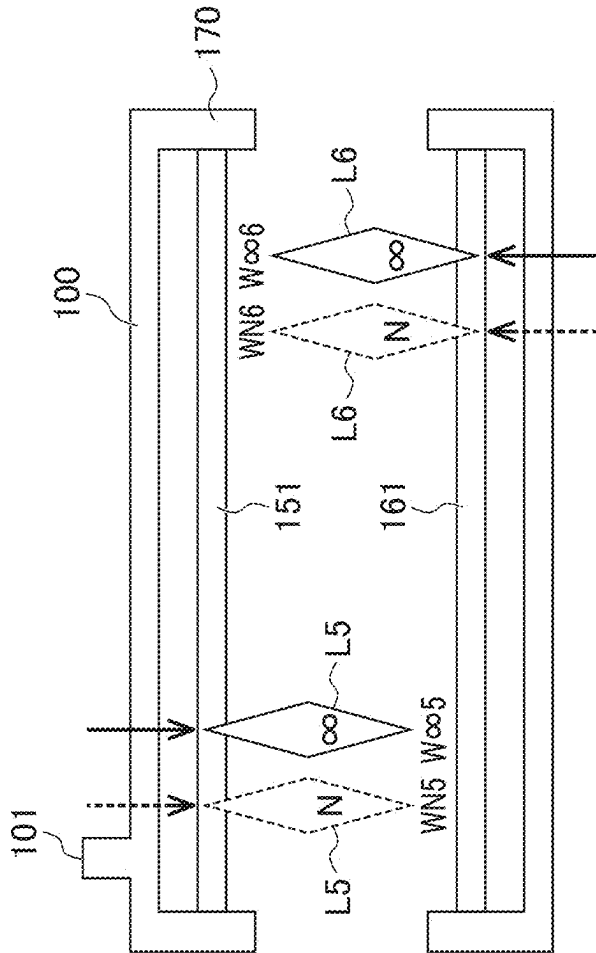


FIG. 5B

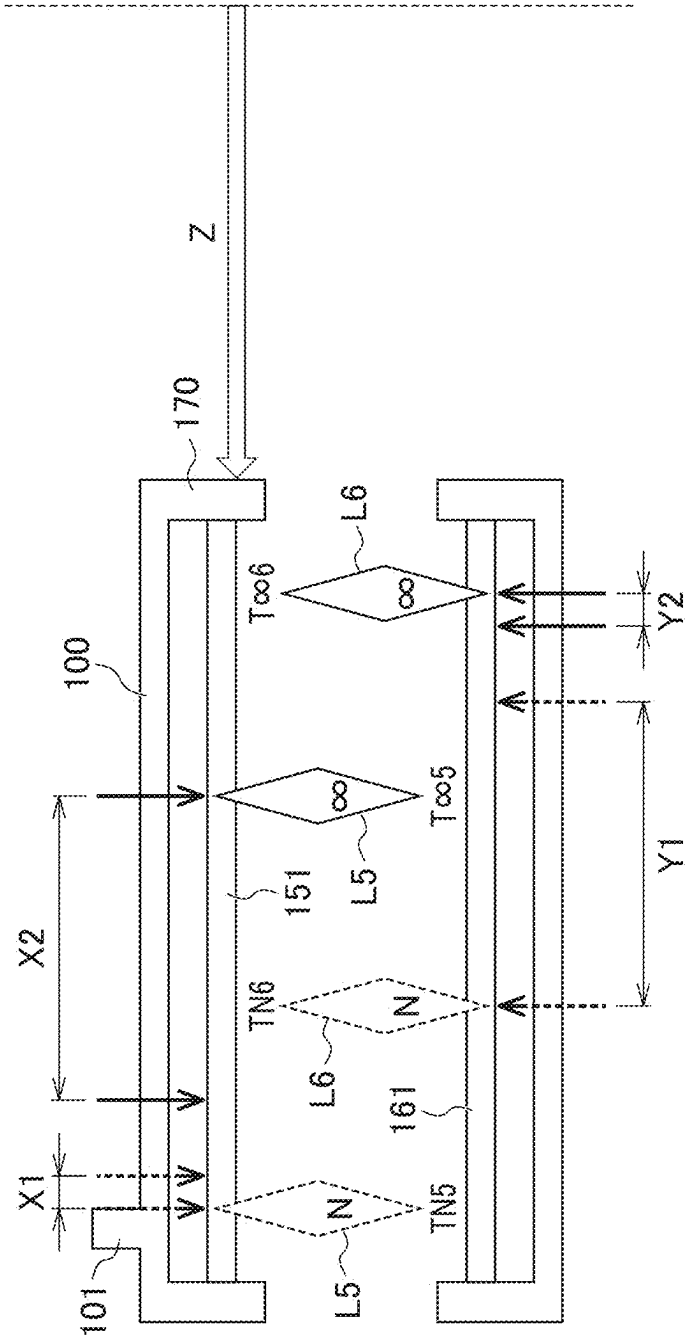


FIG. 6A

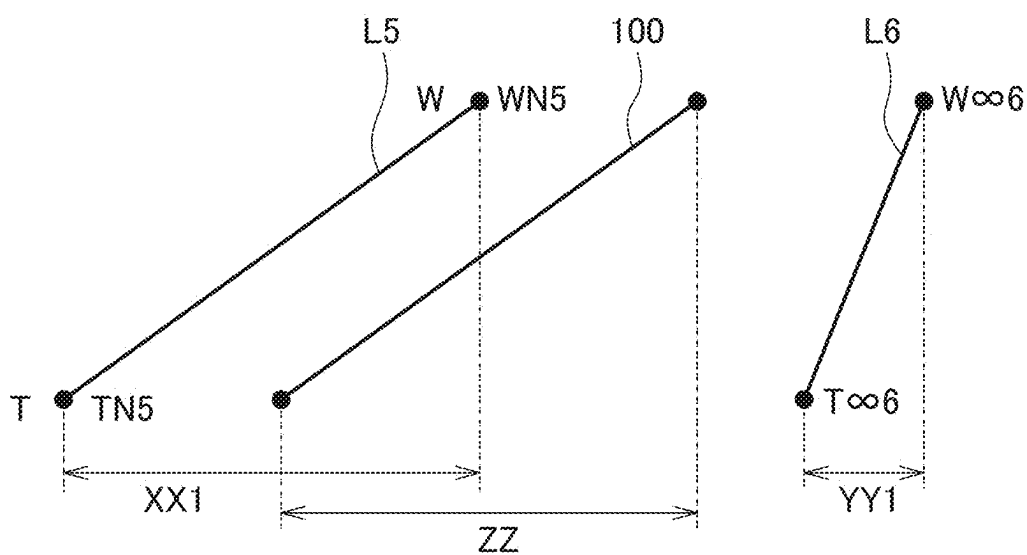
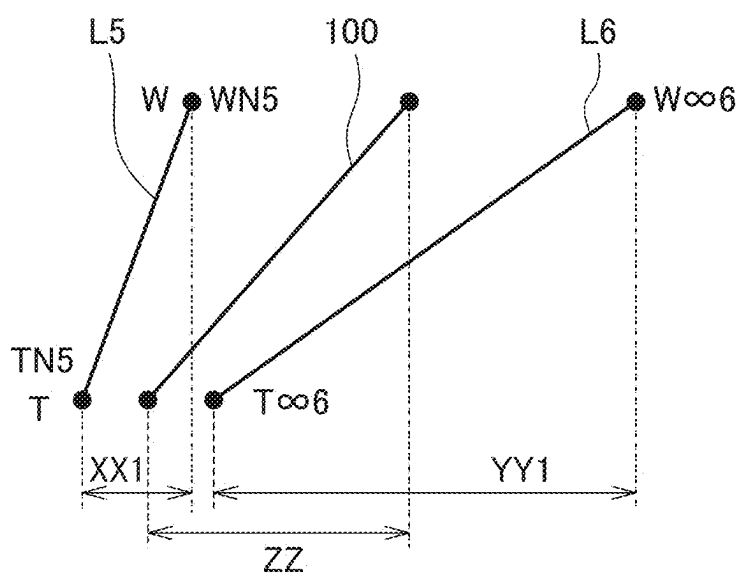


FIG. 6B



LENS BARREL AND IMAGING DEVICE

RELATED APPLICATIONS

[0001] This application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/630,026, filed Apr. 9, 2024, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/430,486, filed Aug. 12, 2021, which is a national stage entry of PCT/JP2019/049636, filed Dec. 18, 2019, which claims priority to Japanese Patent Application No. 2019-030092, filed Feb. 22, 2019. The contents of these prior applications are incorporated by reference herein in their entireties.

TECHNICAL FIELD

[0002] The present invention relates to a lens barrel and an imaging device.

BACKGROUND ART

[0003] Various proposals have heretofore been made, in which a focus lens is provided and driven by a motor (e.g., see Japanese Unexamined Patent Application, Publication No. 2015-49334). Further downsizing of a lens barrel is desired.

[0004] Patent Document 1: Japanese Unexamined Patent Application, Publication No. 2015-49334

DISCLOSURE OF THE INVENTION

[0005] A lens barrel of a first aspect is configured to include: a moving tube that moves along an optical axis when changing a focal length; a first driving part provided to the moving tube; a first lens that relatively moves along the optical axis with respect to the moving tube by the first driving part; a second driving part provided to the moving tube; and a second lens that relatively moves along the optical axis with respect to the moving tube by the second driving part, in which a moving distance of the first lens with respect to the moving tube, in a case of changing a focal length to a second focal length in a first state in which the first lens is arranged closest to a subject side at a first focal length, is smaller than a moving distance of the first lens with respect to the moving tube, in a case of changing a focal length to the second focal length in a second state in which the first lens is arranged closer to an image surface side at the first focal length than in the first state.

[0006] A lens barrel of a second aspect is configured to include: a moving tube that moves along an optical axis when changing a focal length; a first driving part provided to the moving tube; a first lens that relatively moves along the optical axis with respect to the moving tube by the first driving part; a second driving part provided to the moving tube; and a second lens that relatively moves along the optical axis with respect to the moving tube by the second driving part, in which a moving distance of the first lens with respect to the moving tube, in a case of changing a focal length to a second focal length in a first state in which the first lens is arranged closest to a subject side at a first focal length, is smaller than a moving distance of the second lens with respect to the moving tube, in a case of changing a focal length to the second focal length in the first state.

[0007] A lens barrel of a third aspect is configured to include: a moving tube that moves along an optical axis when changing a focal length; a first driving part provided to the moving tube; a first lens that relatively moves along the optical axis with respect to the moving tube by the first

driving part; a second driving part provided to the moving tube; and a second lens that relatively moves along the optical axis with respect to the moving tube by the second driving part, in which a moving distance of the first lens arranged closest to a subject side in a case of changing a focal length is smaller than a moving distance of the second lens arranged closest to the subject side in a case of changing a focal length.

[0008] An imaging device of a fourth aspect is configured to include the lens barrel described above.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0009] FIG. 1 is a conceptual diagram of a camera 1 configured by attaching a lens barrel 2 as an embodiment to a camera body 3;

[0010] FIG. 2 is a perspective view of an inner cam tube 83 of the lens barrel 2, and tube members arranged on an inner diameter side thereof;

[0011] FIG. 3 is a perspective view observed from a side opposite to FIG. 2 by removing the inner cam tube 83 from FIG. 2;

[0012] FIG. 4 is a diagram illustrating only a driving mechanism of a unit-five frame 50 by removing a motor moving tube 100 from FIG. 3;

[0013] FIGS. 5A and 5B are diagrams illustrating a moving state of a unit-five lens L5 and a unit-six lens L6, in which the zoom position is a wide-angle end in FIG. 5A and a telescopic end in FIG. 5B; and

[0014] FIGS. 6A and 6B are diagrams illustrating a moving distance of the unit-five lens L5, a moving distance of the unit-six lens L6, and a moving distance of the motor moving tube 100, in a case of changing the focal length from the wide-angle end (W) to the telescopic end (T).

PREFERRED MODE FOR CARRYING OUT THE INVENTION

[0015] FIG. 1 is a conceptual diagram of a camera 1 as an imaging device, which is configured by mounting a lens barrel 2 as an embodiment to a camera body 3. In the following description, the subject side of the lens barrel 2 in an optical axis OA direction is referred to as a front side, and the camera body 3 side is referred to as a rear side. Movement of the lens barrel 2 in the optical axis OA direction is referred to as “linear travel”, and rotational movement thereof around the optical axis OA is referred to as “rotation”. In a radial direction orthogonal to the optical axis OA of the lens barrel 2, the side separating from the optical axis OA is referred to as an outer diameter side, and the side approaching the optical axis OA is referred to as an inner diameter side.

[0016] The camera 1 includes the camera body 3 and the lens barrel 2. The lens barrel 2 is provided with a lens mount LM on a rear part (proximal end) thereof, engages with a body mount BM of the camera body 3, and is thereby detachably mounted to the camera body 3.

[0017] The camera body 3 is a so-called digital camera, which includes an imaging element 4 for converting an optical image into an electric signal, processes imaging data generated by the imaging element 4, and records the data on a recording part (not illustrated) or displays the data on a display part (not illustrated).

[0018] The camera may be a single-lens reflex camera, a mirrorless camera, a compact digital camera, or a two-lens camera. The camera may be a camera built in a smartphone or tablet.

[0019] The camera body **3** is provided with a power switch (not illustrated). ON/OFF signals of the power switch or signals indicating focusing or aperture values are transmitted to a control part **90** of the lens barrel **2**, which will be described later.

[0020] The lens barrel **2** is a so-called zoom lens capable of changing the focal length, and includes, from the front side: a unit-one lens **L1**, a unit-two lens **L2**, a unit-three lens **L3**, a unit-four lens **L4**, a unit-five lens **L5**, a unit-six lens **L6**, and a unit-seven lens **L7**.

[0021] The unit-one lens **L1**, the unit-two lens **L2**, the unit-three lens **L3**, the unit-four lens **L4**, the unit-five lens **L5**, the unit-six lens **L6**, and the unit-seven lens **L7** move in the optical axis OA direction when zooming.

[0022] The unit-five lens **L5** and the unit-six lens **L6** are focus lens units which move in the motor moving tube **100** when focusing, which will be described later. The lens barrel **2** of the present embodiment is provided with two focus lens units as described above. Therefore, the weight per focus lens unit can be reduced, and even an actuator having a small driving force such as a stepping motor can drive the focus lens unit. Focusing performance can be improved.

[0023] The unit-one lens **L1** is retained in the unit-one frame **10**, and a unit-one sliding tube **12** extends from the unit-one frame **10** to the rear side. The unit-two lens **L2** is retained in the unit-two frame **20**. The unit-three lens **L3** is retained in the unit-three frame **30**. An aperture unit **32** is attached to the front side of the unit-three frame **30**. The unit-four lens **L4** is retained in the unit-four frame **40**, the unit-five lens **L5** is retained in the unit-five frame **50**, the unit-six lens **L6** is retained in the unit-six frame **60**, and the unit-seven lens **L7** is retained in the unit-seven frame **70**.

[0024] The lens barrel **2** includes an outer fixed tube **84** and an inner fixed tube **85**, in which a zoom ring **81** and a focus ring **86** are rotatably provided to an outer circumference of the outer fixed tube **84**. The unit-one sliding tube **12**, an outer cam tube **82**, the inner fixed tube **85**, an inner cam tube **83**, and the motor moving tube **100** are arranged in this order from the outer fixed tube **84** to the inner diameter side.

[0025] A coupling pin (not illustrated) extends from the zoom ring **81** to the inner diameter side. The coupling pin passes through a circumferential groove (not illustrated) provided to the outer fixed tube **84** and is coupled to the outer cam tube **82**. When the zoom ring **81** rotates in the circumferential direction, the coupling pin also rotates in the circumferential direction, and the outer cam tube **82** rotates together with the zoom ring **81**.

[0026] FIG. 2 is a perspective view of the inner cam tube **83** of the lens barrel **2**, and a plurality of tube members arranged on the inner diameter side thereof. The unit-five lens **L5** and the unit-six lens **L6** are not illustrated. A cam follower **92** is provided on the outer diameter side of the inner cam tube **83**. The cam follower **92** passes through a cam groove for driving cam (not illustrated) provided to the inner fixed tube **85**, and is inserted into a linear groove (not illustrated) provided to the outer cam tube **82**. When the outer cam tube **82** rotates in the circumferential direction, the cam follower **92** travels linearly while rotating in the circumferential direction, and the inner cam tube **83** rotates and travels linearly.

[0027] A cam groove **83a** for driving the motor moving tube **100** is provided to the inner cam tube **83**. The groove for driving the motor moving tube **100** provided to the inner cam tube **83** is not limited to a circumferential groove and may be a circumferential groove or a linear groove.

[0028] FIG. 3 is a perspective view observed from the subject side, which is a side opposite to FIG. 2, by removing the inner cam tube **83** from FIG. 2. The cam pin **101** extends from the motor moving tube **100** to the outer diameter side. The cam pin **101** engages with the cam groove **83a** provided to the inner cam tube **83** and a linear groove (not illustrated) of the inner fixed tube **85**.

[0029] When the zoom ring **81** rotates, the inner cam tube **83** travels linearly while rotating, the cam pin **101** causes the motor moving tube **100** to move in a linearly traveling direction without rotation by way of a linearly traveling component of the travel of inner cam tube **83**, and the unit-five lens **L5** and the unit-six lens **L6** travel linearly along with this.

[0030] A main guide bar **151** and a sub guide bar **152** for the unit five, and a main guide bar **161** and a sub guide bar **162** for the unit six extend between a front wall part **103** of the motor moving tube **100** and a guide bar holding member **170** (illustrated in FIG. 1). The main guide bar **151**, the sub guide bar **152**, the main guide bar **161**, and the sub guide bar **162** extend in the optical axis OA direction, at substantially the same position in an overlapping manner. The guide bars are not limited thereto and may overlap with each other at least in part in the optical axis OA direction.

[0031] A unit-five driving part **5M** such as a stepping motor and a unit-six driving part **6M** such as a stepping motor are fixed to the motor moving tube **100**. The unit-five driving part **5M** and the unit-six driving part **6M** are not limited to a stepping motor, and may be a motor such as a voice coil motor or an ultrasonic motor.

[0032] FIG. 4 is a diagram illustrating only a driving mechanism of the unit-five frame **50**, in which the motor moving tube **100** is removed from FIG. 3. The driving mechanism of the unit-six frame **60** is substantially the same as the driving mechanism of the unit-five frame **50**; therefore, only the driving mechanism of the unit-five frame **50** will be described below, and the driving mechanism of the unit-six frame **60** will be omitted.

[0033] The unit-five frame **50** is provided with the unit-five retaining part **51** covering the outer circumference of the unit-five lens **L5**, a main guide bar engaging part **511** extending from the outer circumference of the unit-five retaining part **51** to the outer diameter side, and a sub guide bar engaging part **512**. The sub guide bar engaging part **512** is provided at a position approximately 180 degrees with respect to the main guide bar **151**.

[0034] The main guide bar engaging part **511** includes a front wall **511a** and a rear wall **511b** provided in front and rear thereof, as well as a side wall **511d** connecting the front wall **511a** and the rear wall **511b**. Each of the front wall **511a** and the rear wall **511b** is provided with a guide bar insertion hole **511e**, through which a main guide bar **151** slidably penetrates, which will be described later.

[0035] A light shielding part **511c** is provided to protrude from the side wall **511d** to the outer diameter side. The light shielding part **511c** is a portion like a rectangular plate extending for a predetermined distance in the optical axis OA direction. The light shielding part **511c** is a member for blocking light from a photo interrupter (PI) **5** attached to the

motor moving tube **100**. The light shielding part **511c** and the photo interrupter **PI5** can detect a position of the unit-five lens **L5**.

[0036] The sub guide bar engaging part **512** is a member provided with a U-shaped groove open to the outer diameter side. The sub guide bar **152** is slidably inserted into the U-shaped groove. The U-shaped groove of the sub guide bar engaging part **512** engages with the sub guide bar **152** as described above, preventing rotation around the main guide bar **151** in the circumferential direction.

[0037] A unit frame **501** screwed onto the motor moving tube **100** is attached to the image side of the unit-five driving part **5M** in the optical axis **OA** direction. A lead screw **502** extends from the unit-five driving part **5M** to the rear side in the optical axis **OA** direction, and has a rear end rotatably retained in the unit frame **501**. The lead screw **502** may be configured to extend to the subject side of the unit-five driving part **5M** in the optical axis **OA** direction, depending on the moving range of the unit-five lens **L5**.

[0038] A moving rack **503** engages with the lead screw **502**. The moving rack **503** is retained by the main guide bar engaging part **511**.

[0039] Returning to FIG. 1, a main circuit board **88** is attached to the end of the rear side of the inner fixed tube **85** by screws. The main circuit board **88** includes the control part **90**; when the focus ring **86** or the zoom ring **81** rotates, a rotational amount thereof is detected and inputted to the control part **90**.

[0040] When a photographer performs a focusing operation such as pressing the release halfway down, the camera body **3** inputs a signal to the control part **90**.

[0041] Then, the control part **90** transmits a pulse to the unit-five driving part **5M**, driving the unit-five driving part **5M**. When the unit-five driving part **5M** is driven, the lead screw **502** illustrated in the drawings such as FIG. 4 rotates, and the moving rack **503** engaging with the lead screw **502** moves in the optical axis **OA** direction (direction along the optical axis **OA**). When the moving rack **503** moves, the main guide bar **151** guides the main guide bar engaging part **511** to travel linearly, and the unit-five frame **50** and the unit-five lens **L5** move in the optical axis **OA** direction.

[0042] In a similar manner, the unit-six frame **60** and the unit-six lens **L6** are driven in the optical axis **OA** direction by the unit-six driving part **6M** when zooming or focusing. As described above, the unit-five lens **L5** moves in the optical axis direction by the motor moving tube **100** and the unit-five driving part **5M**.

[0043] Therefore, the moving distance of the unit-five lens **L5** is divided into a distance moved by the motor moving tube **100** and a distance moved by the unit-five driving part **5M**. In the case of the unit-six lens **L6** as well, the moving distance of the unit-six lens **L6** is divided into a distance moved by the motor moving tube **100** and a distance moved by the unit-six driving part **6M**.

[0044] FIGS. 5A and 5B are diagrams illustrating a moving state of the unit-five lens **L5** and the unit-six lens **L6**, in which the zoom position is a wide-angle end **W** in FIG. 5A and a telescopic end **T** in FIG. 5B.

[0045] In the present embodiment, as described above, the lens barrel **2** includes: the motor moving tube **100** including the cam pin **101** and being movable along the optical axis **OA** when changing the focal length; the unit-five driving part **5M** provided to the motor moving tube **100**; the unit-five lens **L5** being movable along the optical axis **OA**

with respect to the motor moving tube **100** by the unit-five driving part **5M**; the unit-six driving part **6M** provided to the motor moving tube **100**; and the unit-six lens **L6** being movable along the optical axis **OA** with respect to the motor moving tube **100** by the unit-six driving part **6M**. For simplicity, FIGS. 5A and 5B omit the unit-five driving part **5M**, the unit-five frame **50**, the unit-six driving part **6M**, the unit-six frame **60**, the sub guide bar **152**, the sub guide bar **162**, etc.

[0046] An example will be described below, in which the first focal length is described as the wide-angle end **W**, and the second focal length is described as the telescopic end **T**. At the first focal length (wide-angle end **W**) and the second focal length (telescopic end **T**), the unit-five lens **L5** is arranged closest to the subject side when the subject distance is “near” **N**, and arranged closest to the image surface side when the subject distance is “infinity” ∞ . At the first focal length (wide-angle end **W**) and the second focal length (telescopic end **T**), the unit-six lens **L6** is arranged closest to the subject side when the subject distance is “near” **N**, and arranged closest to the image surface side when the subject distance is “infinity” ∞ .

(1) Relationship Between the Moving Distances **X1** and **X2** of the Unit-Five Lens **L5**

[0047] As illustrated in FIG. 5A, **WN5** of FIG. 5A indicates the position of the unit-five lens **L5** in a first state (**WN**), in which the unit-five lens **L5** is arranged closest to the subject side, at the first focal length (wide-angle end **W**). When the focal length is changed from the state **WN5** illustrated in FIG. 5A to the second focal length (telescopic end **T**), the unit-five lens **L5** moves to a position **TN5** illustrated in FIG. 5B. **X1** indicates the moving distance of the unit-five lens **L5** with respect to the motor moving tube **100**, in the case of changing the focal length from the first state (**WN**) to the second focal length (telescopic end **T**) without changing the subject distance.

[0048] **W ∞ 5** illustrated in FIG. 5A indicates the position of the unit-five lens **L5** in a second state (**W ∞**), in which the unit-five lens **L5** is arranged closest to the image surface side, at the first focal length (wide-angle end **W**) illustrated in FIG. 5A. When the focal length is changed from the state **W ∞ 5** illustrated in FIG. 5A to the second focal length (telescopic end **T**), the unit-five lens **L5** moves to the position **T ∞ 5** illustrated in FIG. 5B. **X2** indicates the moving distance of the unit-five lens **L5** with respect to the motor moving tube **100**, in the case of changing the focal length from the second state (**W ∞**) to the second focal length (telescopic end **T**) without changing the subject distance.

[0049] In this case, the moving distance **Z** of the motor moving tube **100** is set such that the moving distance **X1** is smaller than the moving distance **X2**.

[0050] In other words, the driving distance **X1** of the unit-five driving part **5M** in the case of changing the focal length from the first state **WN5** illustrated in FIG. 5A to the second focal length (telescopic end **T**) is smaller than the driving distance **X2** of the unit-five driving part **5M** in the case of changing the focal length from the second state **W ∞ 5** illustrated in FIG. 5A to the second focal length (telescopic end **T**).

[0051] Alternatively, the moving distance **X1** of the unit-five lens **L5** with respect to the main guide bar **151** in the case of changing the focal length from the first state **WN5** illustrated in FIG. 5A to the second focal length (telescopic

end T) is smaller than the moving distance X2 of the unit-five lens L5 with respect to the main guide bar 151 in the case of changing the focal length from the second state $W\infty$ illustrated in FIG. 5A to the second focal length (T). [0052] This allows for reducing the moving distance X1 of the unit-five lens L5 with respect to the motor moving tube 100 in the case of changing the focal length from the state in which the unit-five lens L5 is arranged closest to the subject side; therefore, the main guide bar 151 and the motor moving tube 100 do not need to extend to the subject side. Therefore, the size can be thinner in the optical axis direction.

(2) Relationship Between the Moving Distance X1 of the Unit-Five Lens L5 and the Moving Distance Y1 of the Unit-Six Lens L6

[0053] As illustrated in FIG. 5A, WN6 of FIG. 5A indicates the position of the unit-six lens L6 in the first state (WN), in which the unit-six lens L6 is arranged closest to the subject side, at the first focal length (wide-angle end W). When the focal length is changed from the state WN6 illustrated in FIG. 5A to the second focal length (telescopic end T), the unit-six lens L6 moves to the position TN6 illustrated in FIG. 5B. Y1 indicates the moving distance of the unit-six lens L6 with respect to the motor moving tube 100, in the case of changing the focal length from the first state (WN) to the second focal length (telescopic end T) without changing the subject distance. Y1 may be a moving distance of the unit-six lens L6 with respect to the main guide bar 161 in the case of changing the focal length from the first state (WN) to the second focal length (telescopic end T), or may be a driving distance of the unit-six driving part 6M.

[0054] In this case, the moving distance Z of the motor moving tube 100 is set such that the moving distance X1 is smaller than the moving distance Y1.

[0055] This allows for reducing the moving distance X1 of the unit-five lens L5 with respect to the motor moving tube 100 in the case of changing the focal length from the state in which the unit-five lens L5 is arranged closest to the subject side; therefore, the main guide bar 151 and the motor moving tube 100 do not need to extend to the subject side. Therefore, the size can be thinner in the optical axis direction.

Effects of (1) and (2)

[0056] The unit-five lens L5 is arranged on the subject side, and the unit-six lens L6 is arranged on the image side, in the motor moving tube 100.

[0057] When the moving distance with respect to the motor moving tube 100 or the guide bar 151 by zooming is increased in the state in which the unit-five lens L5 arranged on the subject side of the motor moving tube 100 is arranged closest to the subject side, the length of the main guide bar 151 and the sub guide bar 152 or the length of the motor moving tube 100 needs to be increased, resulting in up-sizing.

[0058] According to the present embodiment, the moving distance with respect to the motor moving tube 100 or the guide bar 151 by zooming is reduced in the state in which the unit-five lens L5 arranged on the subject side of the motor moving tube 100 is arranged closest to the subject side; therefore, the length of the main guide bar 151 and the

sub guide bar 152 does not need to be increased, and the lens barrel 2 can be downsized and thinned.

(3) Relationship Between the Moving Distances Y1 and Y2 of the Unit-Six Lens L6

[0059] As illustrated in FIG. 5A, $W\infty$ of FIG. 5A indicates the position of the unit-six lens L6 in the second state ($W\infty$), in which the unit-six lens L6 is arranged closest to the image surface side, at the first focal length (wide-angle end W). When the focal length is changed from the state of $W\infty$ illustrated in FIG. 5A to the second focal length (telescopic end T), the unit-six lens L6 moves to the position T ∞ 6 illustrated in FIG. 5B. Y2 indicates the moving distance of the unit-six lens L6 with respect to the motor moving tube 100, in the case of changing the focal length from the second state ($W\infty$) to the second focal length (telescopic end T) without changing the subject distance. Y2 may be a moving distance of the unit-six lens L6 with respect to the main guide bar 161 in the case of changing the focal length from the second state ($W\infty$) to the second focal length (telescopic end T), or may be a driving distance of the unit-six driving part 6M.

[0060] In this case, the moving distance Z of the motor moving tube 100 is set such that Y2 is smaller than Y1. This allows for reducing the moving distance Y2 of the unit-six lens L6 with respect to the motor moving tube 100 in the case of changing the focal length from the state in which the unit-six lens L6 is arranged closest to the image surface side; therefore, the main guide bar 161 and the motor moving tube 100 do not need to extend to the image surface side. Therefore, the size can be thinner in the optical axis direction.

(4) Relationship Between the Moving Distance X2 of the Unit-Five Lens L5 and the Moving Distance Y2 of the Unit-Six Lens L6

[0061] The moving distance Z of the motor moving tube 100 is set such that the moving distance Y2 of the unit-six lens L6 with respect to the motor moving tube 100 in the case of changing the focal length from the second state ($W\infty$) to the second focal length (telescopic end T) is smaller than the moving distance X2 of the unit-five lens L5 with respect to the motor moving tube 100 in the case of changing the focal length from the second state ($W\infty$) to the second focal length (telescopic end T).

[0062] This allows for reducing the moving distance Y2 of the unit-six lens L6 with respect to the motor moving tube 100 in the case of changing the focal length from the state in which the unit-six lens L6 is arranged closest to the image surface side; therefore, the main guide bar 161 and the motor moving tube 100 do not need to extend to the image surface side. Therefore, the size can be thinner in the optical axis direction.

Effects of (3) and (4)

[0063] The unit-five lens L5 is arranged on the subject side, and the unit-six lens L6 is arranged on the image side, in the motor moving tube 100.

[0064] When the moving distance with respect to the motor moving tube 100 or the guide bar 161 by zooming is increased in the state in which the unit-six lens L6 arranged on the image side of the motor moving tube 100 is arranged closest to the image side, the length of the main guide bar

161 and the sub guide bar **162** or the length of the motor moving tube **100** needs to be increased, resulting in up-sizing.

[0065] According to the present embodiment, the moving distance with respect to the motor moving tube **100** or the guide bar **161** by zooming is reduced in the state in which the unit-six lens **L6** arranged on the image side of the motor moving tube **100** is arranged closest to the image side; therefore, the length of the main guide bar **161** and the sub guide bar **162** does not need to be increased, and the lens barrel **2** can be downsized.

(5) Positional Relationship Between the Unit-Five Lens **L5** and the Unit-Six Lens **L6**

[0066] The unit-six lens **L6** (**WN6**) in the first state (wide-angle end **W**; near state **N**) is arranged closer to the image surface side than the unit-five lens **L5** (**W ∞ 5**) in the second state (wide-angle end **W**; infinity state ∞). The unit-six lens **L6** in the case of changing the focal length from the first state (**WN**) to the second focal length (telescopic end **T**) (**TN6**) is arranged closer to the subject side than the unit-five lens **L5** (**T ∞ 5**) in the case of changing the focal length from the second state (**W ∞**) to the second focal length (telescopic end **T**). Specifically, as illustrated in FIGS. **5A** and **5B**, the positional relationship between the position of arranging the unit-five lens **L5** closest to the image surface side at the wide-angle end **W** (**W ∞ 5**) and the position of arranging the unit-six lens **L6** closest to the subject side (**WN6**) is opposite to the position of arranging the unit-five lens **L5** closest to the image surface side at the telescopic end **T** (**T ∞ 5**) and the position of arranging the unit-six lens **L6** closest to the subject side (**TN6**). This allows the unit-five lens **L5** to move further to the image surface side, and the unit-six lens **L6** to move further to the subject side, allowing wider movement within the range of the guide bars **151** and **161** and the motor moving tube **100**.

Effects of (5)

[0067] With the lens barrel **2** in which the unit-five lens **L5** and the unit-six lens **L6** move in the same direction from the near **N** state to the infinity ∞ state, the positional relationship changes between the infinite state of the unit-five lens **L5** (**W ∞ 5**) and the near state (**WN6**) of the unit-six lens **L6** at the wide-angle end **W**, and the positional relationship changes between the infinite state (**T ∞ 5**) of the unit-five lens **L5** and the near state (**TN6**) of the unit-six lens **L6** at the telescopic end **T**.

[0068] This allows for efficiently using the guide bars **151**, **152**, **161** and **162** for guiding the unit-five lens **L5** and the unit-six lens **L6**; therefore, the lens barrel **2** can be downsized and thinned.

[0069] (6) FIG. **6** is a diagram illustrating the moving distance of the unit-five lens **L5** in the near **N** state, the moving distance of the unit-six lens **L6** in the infinity ∞ state, and the moving distance of the motor moving tube **100**, in the case of changing the focal length from the wide-angle end **W** to the telescopic end **T**.

[0070] **XX1** indicates the moving distance of the unit-five lens **L5** in the case of changing the focal length from the wide-angle end **W** to the telescopic end **T**, in the near **N** state. **YY1** indicates the moving distance of the unit-six lens **L6** in the case of changing the focal length from the wide-angle end **W** to the telescopic end **T**, in the infinity ∞ state. **ZZ**

indicates the moving distance of the motor moving tube **100** in the case of changing the focal length from the wide-angle end **W** to the telescopic end **T**.

[0071] In the present embodiment, the moving distance **ZZ** of the motor moving tube **100** in the case in which the moving distance **XX1** of the unit-five lens **L5** is larger than the moving distance **YY1** of the unit-six lens **L6** as illustrated in FIG. **6A** is larger than the moving distance **ZZ** of the motor moving tube **100** in the case in which the moving distance **XX1** of the unit-five lens **L5** is smaller than the moving distance **YY1** of the unit-six lens **L6** as illustrated in FIG. **6B**.

Effects of (6)

[0072] By setting a movement path of the motor moving tube **100** as described above, both **X1** and **Y2** in FIG. **5B** can be reduced.

[0073] (7) When the lens barrel **2** zooms from the wide-angle end **W** to the telescopic end **T**, the motor moving tube **100** moves in the optical axis **OA** direction. The unit-five lens **L5** and the unit-six lens **L6** move with respect to the motor moving tube **100** by the unit-five driving part **5M** and the unit-six driving part **6M**.

[0074] In this case, the unit-five lens **L5** and the unit-six lens **L6** move in a single direction with respect to the motor moving tube **100**. Specifically, the unit-five lens **L5** and the cam pin **101** of the motor moving tube **100**, for example, are in a positional relationship of always separating away when zooming in the focused state at infinity ∞ . The unit-six lens **L6** and the cam pin **101** of the motor moving tube **100**, for example, are also in a positional relationship of always separating away when zooming in the focused state at infinity ∞ .

[0075] However, the present invention is not limited thereto; and the unit-five lens **L5** as well as the unit-six lens **L6** and the cam pin **101** of the motor moving tube **100**, for example, may be in a positional relationship of always approaching or being constant, when zooming in the focused state at infinity ∞ .

[0076] The unit-five lens **L5** as well as the unit-six lens **L6** and the motor moving tube **100** at the near **N** may be in a positional relationship of always approaching, separating, or being constant, when zooming in the focused state at infinity ∞ .

Effects of (7)

[0077] When the unit-five lens **L5** as well as the unit-six lens **L6** and the motor moving tube **100** are in a positional relationship of moving in opposite directions instead of a single direction (in the case of U-turning) when zooming in the focused state at infinity ∞ , the unit-five driving part **5M** and the unit-six driving part **6M** will rotate in the opposite directions.

[0078] Then, a delay may be caused by looseness between the unit-five driving part **5M** as well as the unit-six driving part **6M** and the lead screw.

[0079] However, in the present embodiment, the unit-five driving part **5M** and the unit-six driving part **6M** constantly rotate in a single direction; therefore, looseness does not occur, and a delay in movement does not occur.

[0080] The lens barrel **2** is more likely to be zoomed in the infinity state than in the near state; therefore, reverse rotation may be prevented in the infinity state as in the case of the

present embodiment. However, reverse rotation may be prevented in the near state, or reverse rotation may be prevented in in both the infinity state and the near state.

[0081] The embodiment has been described above, in which the first focal length is the wide-angle end W and the second focal length is the telephoto end T; however, the present invention is not limited thereto. For example, the first focal length may be a middle 1, and the second focal length may be a middle 2 having a longer focal length than the middle 1.

[0082] The embodiment has been described above, in which the unit-five lens L5 is arranged closest to the subject side in the case in which the subject distance is the near N at the wide-angle end W and the telephoto end T, and arranged closest to the image surface side in the case in which the subject distance is the infinity ∞ ; however, the present invention is not limited thereto. For example, the unit-five lens L5 may be arranged closest to the subject side in the case in which the subject distance is the infinity ∞ , and may be arranged closest to the image surface side in the case in which the subject distance is the near N.

[0083] The embodiment has been described above, in which the unit-six lens L6 is arranged closest to the subject side in the case in which the subject distance is the near N, and arranged closest to the image surface side in the case in which the subject distance is the infinity ∞ , at the first focal length (wide-angle end W) and the second focal length (telephoto end T); however, the present invention is not limited thereto. For example, the unit-six lens L6 may be arranged closest to the subject side in the case in which the subject distance is the infinity ∞ , and may be arranged closest to the image surface side in the case in which the subject distance is the near N.

[0084] It should be noted that the present invention is not limited to the above-described embodiments, and any combination thereof may be used.

EXPLANATION OF REFERENCE NUMERALS

[0085] OA: optical axis; 2: lens barrel; 3: camera body; 5M: unit-five driving part; 50: unit-five frame; 51: unit-five retaining part; 6M: unit-six driving part; 60: unit-six frame; 81: zoom ring; 82: outer cam tube; 83: inner cam tube; 84: outer fixed tube; 85: inner fixed tube; 86: focus ring; 90: control part; 92: cam follower; 100: motor moving tube; 101: cam pin; 103: front wall part; 151: main guide bar; 152: sub guide bar; 161: main guide bar; 162: sub guide bar; 170: guide bar holding member; 501: unit frame; 502: lead screw; 503: moving rack; 511: main guide bar engaging part; 511a: front wall; 511b: rear wall; 511c: light shielding part; 511d: side wall; 511e: guide bar insertion hole; 512: sub guide bar engaging part

1. A lens barrel, comprising:

an optical system including a unit-one lens, a unit-two lens, a unit-three lens, a unit-four lens, a unit-five lens, and a unit-six lens arranged in this order from a subject side;

a moving tube that moves along an optical axis when changing a focal length;

a first driving part provided to the moving tube; and

a second driving part provided to the moving tube, wherein

the unit-five lens relatively moves along the optical axis with respect to the moving tube by the first driving part when focusing,

the unit-six lens relatively moves along the optical axis with respect to the moving tube by the second driving part when focusing, and

a moving distance of the unit-five lens with respect to the moving tube, in a case of changing a focal length to a telephoto end in a first state in which the unit-five lens is arranged closest to the subject side at a wide-angle end, is smaller than a moving distance of the unit-five lens with respect to the moving tube, in a case of changing a focal length from the wide-angle end to the telephoto end in a second state in which the unit-five lens is arranged closer to an image surface side at the wide-angle end than in the first state.

2. The lens barrel according to claim 1, wherein

a moving distance of the unit-six lens with respect to the moving tube, in a case of changing a focal length from the wide-angle end to the telephoto end in the second state, is smaller than a moving distance of the unit-six lens with respect to the moving tube, in a case of changing a focal length from the wide-angle end to the telephoto end in the first state.

3. The lens barrel according to claim 1, wherein

a moving distance of the unit-six lens with respect to the moving tube, in a case of changing a focal length from the wide-angle end to the telephoto end in the second state, is smaller than a moving distance of the unit-five lens with respect to the moving tube, in a case of changing a focal length from the wide-angle end to the telephoto end in the second state.

4. The lens barrel according to claim 1, wherein

the unit-six lens in the second state is arranged closer to the image surface side than in the first state.

5. The lens barrel according to claim 1, wherein

the moving tube includes a cam follower, and

the unit-six lens moves in a certain direction with respect to the cam follower in a case of changing a focal length in the first state or the second state.

6. The lens barrel according to claim 1, wherein

the unit-five lens in the first state moves toward the image surface side in a case of changing a focal length from the wide-angle end to the telephoto end.

7. The lens barrel according to claim 1, wherein

the unit-six lens in the first state moves toward the image surface side in a case of changing a focal length from the wide-angle end to the telephoto end.

8. The lens barrel according to claim 1, wherein

a moving distance of the moving tube, in a case in which a moving distance of the unit-five lens in a case of changing a focal length from the wide-angle end to the telephoto end in the first state is larger than a moving distance of the unit-six lens in a case of changing a focal length from the wide-angle end to the telephoto end in the second state, is larger than a moving distance of the moving tube, in a case in which a moving distance of the unit-five lens in a case of changing a focal length from the wide-angle end to the telephoto end in the first state is smaller than a moving distance of the unit-six lens in a case of changing a focal length from the wide-angle end to the telephoto end in the second state.

9. A lens barrel, comprising:
an optical system including a unit-one lens, a unit-two lens, a unit-three lens, a unit-four lens, a unit-five lens, and a unit-six lens arranged in this order from a subject side;
a moving tube that moves along an optical axis when changing a focal length;
a first driving part provided to the moving tube; and
a second driving part provided to the moving tube, wherein
the unit-five lens relatively moves along the optical axis with respect to the moving tube by the first driving part when focusing, and
the unit-six lens relatively moves along the optical axis with respect to the moving tube by the second driving part when focusing, and
a moving distance of the unit-five lens with respect to the moving tube, in a case of changing a focal length from a wide-angle end to a telephoto end in a first state in which the unit-five lens is arranged closest to the subject side at the wide-angle end, is smaller than a moving distance of the unit-six lens with respect to the moving tube, in a case of changing a focal length from the wide-angle end to the telephoto end in the first state.

10. A lens barrel, comprising:
an optical system including a unit-one lens, a unit-two lens, a unit-three lens, a unit-four lens, a unit-five lens, and a unit-six lens arranged in this order from a subject side;
a moving tube that moves along an optical axis when changing a focal length;
a first driving part provided to the moving tube; and
a second driving part provided to the moving tube, wherein

when focusing, the unit-five lens moves toward an image surface side along the optical axis with respect to the moving tube by the first driving part,
when focusing, the unit-six lens moves toward the image surface side along the optical axis with respect to the moving tube by the second driving part, and
a moving distance of the unit-five lens arranged closest to the subject side in a case of changing a focal length is smaller than a moving distance of the unit-six lens arranged closest to the subject side in a case of changing a focal length.

11. An imaging device, comprising the lens barrel according to claim 1.

12. An imaging device, comprising the lens barrel according to claim 2.

13. An imaging device, comprising the lens barrel according to claim 3.

14. An imaging device, comprising the lens barrel according to claim 4.

15. An imaging device, comprising the lens barrel according to claim 5.

16. An imaging device, comprising the lens barrel according to claim 6.

17. An imaging device, comprising the lens barrel according to claim 7.

18. An imaging device, comprising the lens barrel according to claim 8.

19. An imaging device, comprising the lens barrel according to claim 9.

20. An imaging device, comprising the lens barrel according to claim 10.

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